



HP Compaq 2510p

The Tough Ultraportable

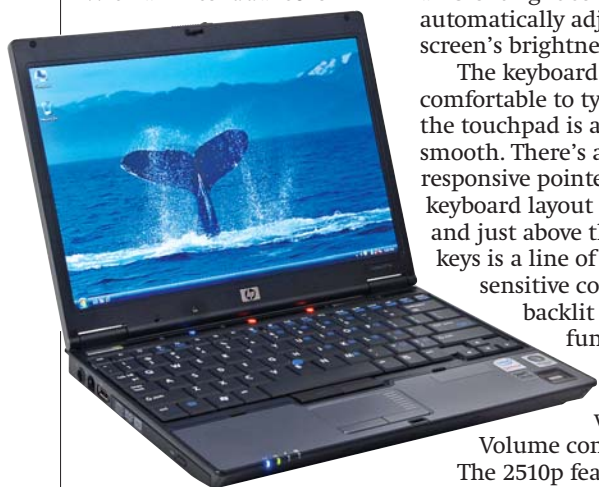
Designed from a pure usability point-of-view, this little baby is built like a tank. The construction is rugged in general, and we liked the sturdiness of the hinges in particular. It's not as flashy-looking as its competitors, but it's sleek, and weighs just 1.29 kg. With an Intel dual-core

processor and a decent amount of RAM, while running Windows Vista Business, this laptop packs in enough power to cater to business needs. The processor's and hard drive's focus is on increased battery life.

The 2510p sports a widescreen (WXGA). An ambient light sensor automatically adjusts the screen's brightness.

The keyboard is very comfortable to type on, but the touchpad is a little too smooth. There's also a highly responsive pointer-stick. The keyboard layout is good, and just above the function keys is a line of touch-sensitive cool-blue

backlit buttons for functions such as Turning On/Off wireless, Volume control, etc. The 2510p features



connectivity in the form of Bluetooth and Wi-Fi as well as Gigabit LAN—and even a legacy modem. It has a PC Card interface, SD memory slot, two USB ports and a FireWire port. You can buy the HP 2400/2500 Ultra-Light Docking Station to add more ports. There's also a D-Sub connector so you can hook it up to a projector.

Security is taken care of by the biometric fingerprint reader and a host of utilities that can encrypt your hard drive and restrict data access to only authorised users. Even theft or removing the hard drive will not expose your data to prying eyes.

There's not much to complain about with the 2510p; a webcam would have been a great value-add. A

faster hard drive would have improved performance drastically, while reducing battery life marginally. And remember, this laptop is not made for gaming. With a one-year warranty and HP's great support system, the HP Compaq 2510p is a reasonably good buy.

Specifications

Intel Core 2 Duo ULV processor U7600 @ 1.2 GHz; Mobile Intel GM965 chipset; 1 GB 667 MHz DDR2@533 MHz; 80 GB 1.8-inch 4200 rpm PATA hard drive; Intel GMA X3100 graphics with 384 MB shared; DVD-RAM drive; 12.1 inch WXGA anti-glare LCD; Ports: 2 USB, 1 IEEE 1394, Gigabit, RJ-11, D-Sub; Wireless: Intel 802.11a/b/g, Bluetooth 2.0; Dimensions: 282.3(W) x 212.8(D) x 24.7(H) mm; Weight: 1.29 Kg; Battery: 3-cell (28 WHr) high capacity Lithium-Ion

RATINGS

Features	★★★★★
Performance	★★★★★
Build Quality	★★★★★
Value for Money	★★★★★
Overall	★★★★★

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Web site: www.hp.com/in
Price: Rs 89,990 plus taxes

Sandisk Sansa Shaker

Salt 'N' Pepper Cellar This Isn't!

The Shaker is a rather novel concept from Sansa, (and after their audiophile-grade Sansa E2xx series), both a disappointment and a delight. One look at it will delight, but after hearing it perform we were a little disappointed despite the fact that it's supposed to be a fun music player and not a real music player!

The Shaker is dressed in funky wear—bright blue and white and looks like a salt dispenser, complete with the holes on top (loudspeaker). It features two 3.5 mm jacks. There are two white bands running around the top and bottom of the player. Both twist left and right—the top one controls the volume, the

lower skips tracks. There's a large, recessed play/pause button built into the body. Build quality is top class, and a classy aluminium clasp allows it to be belted on.

Sound quality via the 3.5 mm jacks isn't its forte. Music sounds muted across the spectrum. Highs and lows weren't defined at all, while the vocals and mid-range were barely tolerable for someone really into music. If you aren't the discerning type, you could



give it a try. The loudspeaker sounds much better though, and actually made tunes bearable.

When we think *Shaker* all we envision is the average urban kid whose mom and dad don't want to buy something with a breakable LCD screen. At Rs 1,899, the Shaker is good enough to introduce your fresh-in-their-teens kids to the world of PMPs; others might want to give it a pass.

RATINGS

Feature	★★★★★
Performance	★★★★★
Value for Money	★★★★★
Build Quality	★★★★★
Overall	★★★★★

Specifications

Capacity: 512 MB Flash memory, SD expandable slot; Music formats: AAC, MP3, WAV; Dual 3.5 mm audio jacks; Lanyard with aluminium ring

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Price: Rs 1,899